

1. What a VPN *actually* does

A VPN...

- hides your **IP address** from the websites you visit
- encrypts your traffic between **you** → **VPN company**
- prevents your **internet provider** from seeing your browsing

A VPN **does NOT**:

- block ads
 - stop tracking pixels
 - block trackers hidden inside apps
 - prevent fingerprinting
 - prevent data brokers from profiling your behavior
 - stop apps from phoning home
 - stop Google, Meta, or your phone OS from collecting telemetry
 - strip metadata
 - fake your identity
 - hide you from data-broker feeds
 - block behavioral analytics
 - stop location leakage
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2. Why your data still gets harvested even with a VPN

Because trackers don't care about your IP address.
They have other ways to identify you with eerie accuracy.

The modern internet fingerprints you like a forensic lab:

- browser fingerprint
- screen resolution
- fonts installed
- device type
- OS version
- time zone
- language
- canvas rendering
- WebGL quirks
- battery API
- motion sensors
- typing rhythm
- cookies
- login behavior
- shopping patterns

- app telemetry
- GPS and Wi-Fi beacons
- advertising ID
- Bluetooth and NFC pings

Your IP address is only one data point in a **basket of 50–200 signals**. A VPN removes one signal. They still have the other 49–199 signals to glue your identity back together.

3. Why DNS matters

If you're not using a private DNS service (NextDNS, ControlD, Firefox hardened):

- your device leaks every app connection
- every invisible “tracking ping” gets logged
- advertisers, data brokers, and ISPs see **where** you're going
 - even when you're using a VPN, DNS *can* bypass it if not forced through the tunnel
- mobile apps bypass browsers altogether

DNS protection does things a VPN cannot:

DNS blocks:

- ad networks
- tracking domains
- telemetry servers
- behavioral analytics script calls
- creepy SDKs inside mobile apps
- fingerprinting endpoints
- phishing domains
- spyware servers
- data-broker ingestion endpoints
- AI training scrapers
- dynamic pricing scripts
- cross-app tracking

DNS gives you:

- visibility into everything your phone tries to talk to
- the ability to break the surveillance economy before it reaches your device
- system-wide control (apps, OS, browsers—all filtered)

You need both.

A VPN hides your IP, but DNS protection blocks the surveillance companies that actually collect and sell your data. Without DNS filtering, your data still leaks through every app, every tracker, every script, and every telemetry ping—even with a VPN on.

4. Simple metaphor

If the internet is a shopping mall:

- **VPN = wearing sunglasses**
People can't see your face, but stores still track everywhere you go.
 - **DNS protection = shutting down the mall cameras and loyalty scanners and wearing an invisibility cloak** It cuts off the entire surveillance infrastructure that operates behind the scenes.
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